

Enterprise Azure

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I wanted to build something that spoke directly to Clear Measure's world; .NET, Onion Architecture, Azure DevOps, as part of getting to know Jeffrey Palermo's work. So I built TaskFlow: a small task-tracking API laid out in the exact layering pattern Jeffrey originated back in 2008. The code part went fine. What actually taught me something was everything Azure threw at me once I tried to ship it.

The first wall was a region restriction. My university's Azure for Students subscription only allows deployment into a specific, undocumented list of regions, I was only able to find the real list by digging into the Azure Policy assignment itself and reading the **"listOfAllowedLocations"** parameter directly, since the portal's own error message just said "contact support." That's when I learned that a lot of what looks like an Azure limitation in a screenshot is actually an organization's own governance layer, not the platform itself.

The second wall was bigger; I couldn't sign into Azure DevOps at all. Every attempt, different browsers, incognito, a different network entirely, even my own phone seemed to silently bounce back to the Azure Portal before I ever reached an account picker. It took a while to realize this wasn't a network issue; it was Conditional Access, enforced at the identity layer, following me across every device tied to my school account. I ended up rebuilding the deployment pipeline around GitHub Actions instead of Azure DevOps, authenticating through the App Service's publish profile; a real design pivot made under a real constraint, not a tutorial's version of DevOps.

After I finally got a deployment out, the site came back as a 503. I dug into it assuming a code bug (and fixed a real one, SQLite couldn't create its own storage folder on Azure's persisted disk). But the deeper cause was that the crash-loop itself, all those failed restart attempts while I was debugging, had burned through my Free-tier plan's entire daily compute quota and gotten the site auto-disabled. Nothing was actually wrong with the fix by that point, I just had to wait for a quota to reset, which is its own kind of lesson: sometimes the system is telling you something true about resource limits, not about your code.

None of this shows up in a tutorial. It's the actual texture of shipping software inside an organization with real governance, real restrictions, and real limits; which, as it turns out, is exactly the kind of problem Clear Measure gets paid to solve for other companies. I didn't expect the most valuable part of this project to be the deployment story instead of the code, but it was.